

Christos Hadjinikolis

ML Tech Lead (Staff-Level) @ Vortexa Ltd | Ph.D.

Committee Expert Member @ JTC'21

✉ christos.hadjinikolis@gmail.com

mediums
🌐 personal website

 **LinkedIn**
 **github**
 **Scholar**
 **YouTube**

languages
bilingual
Greek/English

programming
Java/Kotlin, Python,
SQL, Cypher

author
pypi:dynamicio

developer skills
distributed ML systems,
CI/CD, IaC,
observability,
model/data versioning,
production monitoring

cloud-platforms
AWS, GCP

technologies & frameworks
py/Spark, py/Flink,
Kafka, FastApi, Docker,
MLflow, Airflow,
Elasticsearch

python libs
pandas, numpy, polars

visualisations
Gephi, Seaborn,
plotly/streamlit

interests
Sports: Tennis, Jogging,
Reading: Comics,
Philosophy, Politics

about me

Staff-level ML systems engineer with 15+ years of experience designing and operating production AI systems across data platforms, backend engineering, and platform delivery. Recent work has focused on destination-prediction services, real-time inference pipelines, streaming data infrastructure, and the operational discipline required to move models from experimentation into reliable production. Strong record of owning ambiguous, high-scale problems end-to-end, partnering closely with scientists and engineers, and building observable, maintainable systems around heterogeneous data.

work-experience

Vortexa Ltd, London, UK 12/2020–present

ML Tech Lead (Staff-Level) | Pod Lead

Lead the design and delivery of large-scale ML systems for maritime forecasting, combining destination prediction, streaming infrastructure, backend services, and production rollout discipline. Own technical direction across cross-functional teams and drive the conversion of advanced modelling work into reliable, user-facing systems with measurable operating quality.

- **Data Platform Foundations:** Built distributed Flink and pandas workflows over geospatial, textual, and graph-structured datasets, strengthening dataflow foundations and reducing maintenance effort for downstream training and inference.
- **Production Inference Systems:** Delivered backend model-serving services with versioning, switch-over logic, auditability, and operational safeguards for continuously running prediction systems.
- **Model Lifecycle Engineering:** Built training and inference workflows with CI/CD, online evaluation, and traceable performance monitoring to support dependable deployment over time.
- **Streaming Infrastructure:** Designed Kafka-based pipelines supporting near real-time model refresh and downstream triggers across 15+ ETL components.
- **Staff-Level Ownership:** Led delivery across ML, DS, and DE functions, set engineering standards, and raised execution quality for systems moving from research-grade ideas to production behaviour.

DataReply, London, UK 04/2016–12/2020

Data Scientist | ML Engineer

Progressed from Data Scientist to ML Engineer, leading cross-functional DS/DE teams and delivering production-grade systems across UBS, Vodafone, and CNHi. Work centered on platformisation, observability, deployment workflows, and turning data-science prototypes into maintainable software systems.

- **Vodafone Group (09/2019–11/2020, London):**
 - Worked on Vodafone's internal MLOps platform (**Infinity Project**) on GCP using **Kubeflow**, supporting model versioning, deployment, telemetry, and resource-governed notebooks.
 - Implemented CI/CD pipelines, shared feature and data workflows, and monitoring for reproducible, production-ready ML systems.
- **CNHi (05/2019–09/2019, Chicago):**
 - Built **time-series forecasting** models over connected-vehicle telemetry and helped transition statistical prototypes into scalable, cloud-ready services.
- **UBS (08/2017–04/2019, London):**
 - Designed real-time pipelines using **graph analytics** and **process mining** to surface organisational insights and support decision automation.
 - Developed observability tooling with **Kafka**, **Elasticsearch**, and Python, connecting data infrastructure to downstream analytics and business-facing use cases.

Roles in UK Institutions 2010–2016

Assoc. Lect. @GSM | Coding Teacher @DGC | TA @KCL|UCL

Taught a broad range of computing subjects during doctoral studies, covering both undergraduate and pre-university curricula. The through-line from this period is deep technical communication, strong fundamentals, and the ability to make complex ideas operational for others.

- **2012–2016:** Lectured in Computing, MATLAB, Java, Python, HTML, CSS at GSM and David Game College
- **2010–2014:** TA at King's College London (KCL) and UCL, covering Java, Data Structures, Systems Architecture, Semantic Web, SQL, and AI.

education

2010–2014	Ph.D. in Computer Science <i>Thesis: Persuasion Dialogues & Opponent Modelling.</i> Developed logical inference methods for large Knowledge Graphs , combining symbolic reasoning, graph analytics , and Bayesian techniques (e.g., MCMC). Research contributed to scalable AI systems grounded in formal semantics. Received Best Poster Award at IJCAI 2013 (413 submissions). Awarded EPSRC PhD Scholarship , Outstanding TA Award (student-nominated), and earned the Graduate Certificate in Academic Practice . Access Publications on Google Scholar	King's College London, UK
2004–2010	Diploma (BEng) in Computer Engineering Five-year polytechnic degree in Computer Science and Engineering with a strong focus on mathematics (10 courses), covering theoretical aspects, networking, and telecommunications. Majored in Artificial Intelligence .	University of Thessaly, GR
2002–2004	Military Officer: Second Lieutenant Obligatory army service; position acquired through competitive IQ and athletic exams.	National Guard, CY

committees/affiliations

since 10/2024	University College London, Dept. of Information Studies Support AI application, standardisation, and ethics initiatives in industry and academia.	Associate Researcher
since 01/2021	ISO - International Organisation for Standardisation Member of JTC'21 Working Group 3, developing AI standards aligned with EU policies and international norms.	Committee Expert Member for JTC'21

talks/interviews

2023	Bill Raymonds, Agile in Action Agile Data Science: Sailing Through Data Science: The Agile Journey at Vortexa , Details: YouTube	Podcast Interview
2022	Open Data Science Conference Dynamicio , a python library for abstracting your I/O, Details: here	Industry Conference Talk
2020	iunera: Big Data Innovators The Agile approach in data science explained by an ML expert, Details: here	Interview Blog Post
2020	Big Data Warsaw Monitoring and Analysing Communication and Trade Events as Graphs, Details: here	Industry Conference Talk
2018	Connected Data London AI tribes and interconnections: what's graph got to do with it?, Details: here	Panelist @ Industry Conference
2018	Minds Mastering Machines A talk on doing Data Science the Agile Way, Details: here	Industry Conference Talk

certificates & awards

07/2020	AWS Certified Machine Learning - Specialty Validation Number: D0R0WC7CN1VQ13SV	AWS
01/2019	Process Mining License number: AFU2VTP6273V	Coursera Course Certificates
10/2017	Google Certified Professional - Data Engineer Credential ID: 000000400	Google Cloud Certified
07/2017	Advanced Elasticsearch: Data modelling Enrolment Id: 33442	Elastic
06/2016	Graph Analytics for Big Data License number: NZADYAQ7N8FW	Coursera Course Certificates
05/2016	Apache Spark Developer Certification License number: 1.x-0548	O'Reilly Media
04/2016	Neo4j Certified Professional License number: here	Neo Technology, Creators of Neo4j